INCH-POUND

A-A-20191A
February 29, 1996
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20191
September 19, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CARROTS, FRESH, READY-TO-USE

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers fresh, ready-to-use carrots, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government

2. CLASSIFICATION.

The fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall conform to the following styles as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Styles

Style I - Whole means 3/4 to 1-1/2 inch (1.91 to 3.81 cm) diameter carrots that retain the approximate confirmation of a whole carrot.

Style II - Halves or Halved means 1 to 1-1/2 inch (2.54 to 3.81 cm) diameter carrots cut longitudinally into two units.

Style III - Quarters or Quartered means carrots cut longitudinally into four approximately equal units Carrots cut longitudinally and crosswise into six or eight units approximately the size and appearance of quartered carrots may also be specified.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.

FSC 8915

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Style IV - Slices or Sliced means carrots sliced transversely to the longitudinal axis Slices shall be 3/4 to 1-1/4 inches (1 905 to 3 175 cm) in diameter and 3/16 or 1/4 inch (0 476 or 0 635 cm) in thickness as specified

Style V - Diced means carrots consisting of 1/4 or 3/8 inch (0 635 or 0 954 cm) cube-shaped units as specified

Style VI - Strips including French style and sticks if specified means carrots that consist of longitudinally cut strips 3-1/2 to 4-1/2 inches (8.89 to 11.43 cm) in length and 1/4 to 5/8 inch (0.635 to 6.25 cm) in width and includes such forms as French style and sticks as specified.

Style VII - Shredded or "grated" means medium cut shreds obtained by shredding in accordance with good commercial practice

Style VIII - Baby-cut means carrots consisting of 3/8 to 7/8 inch (0 954 to 2 226 cm) in diameter at the crown. Length not less than 1-1/2 inches (3.82 cm).

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Raw materials: Except for Style VIII - Baby-cut carrots, the carrots shall be U.S. No 1 Grade of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Topped Carrots. Style VIII - Baby-cut carrots shall be well formed and well trimmed. Carrots of any style shall possess similar varietal characteristics.

3.2 Preparation: Ready-to-use carrots shall be clean and sound. Products shall be prepared from the fresh root of the carrot plant (Daucus carota) by washing with potable water, sorting, peeling, trimming, and cutting in accordance with good commercial practice

3.3 Finished product:

3.3 1 Flavor and odor: Carrots of any style shall possess good normal characteristic flavor and odor. The carrots shall be free from objectionable flavors and odors of any kind.

3.3.2 Color: Fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall possess good exterior bright orange-yellow color. Fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall be free from green, or orange-brown units which more than slightly affect the appearance of the product. White color that disappears after a quick rinse with cold potable water prior to serving is acceptable

3.3.3 Texture: The product shall be crisp and firm, but not tough, fibrous, or mushy The fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall possess a practically uniform texture.

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3.3.4 Temperatures: The fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall be kept under refrigeration to maintain quality Unless otherwise recommended, preparation, storage, and delivery temperatures greater than 32°F (0°C) but not more than 40°F (4 4°C) are recommended.

3.3.5 Defects: The prepared fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall be free from defects which materially detract from their appearance or edibility Presence of any decay, off-odor, off-color, or foreign material (e.g.; metal, glass, wood, paint, or insect parts) shall be cause for rejection of the lot

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the fresh ready-to-use carrots within the commercial marketplace. Delivered fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S Department of Agriculture shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in this CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation

5.2 Examination of finished product. For lot sizes of 2 to 501,000 bags and over, 13 bags shall be selected. The sample unit shall be 2 pounds of product from each of 13 bags yielding 13, 2 pound samples. When the lot size is less than 13, examine all units The finished fresh, ready-to-use carrots shall be evaluated for conformance to the salient characteristics. The lot shall be rejected if one or more sample units fail to conform to the salient characteristics.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

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7. NOTES.

7.1 Sources of documents.

7.1.1 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199 This document may be purchased from **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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